



Fed raises key interest rate

3.9%

The quarter-point increase lifts the Fed's key rate to about 3.9% in an attempt to curb spending and inflation. Inflation was 3.7% in July compared with a year ago, up from 2.3% in April 2025, just before President Donald Trump unveiled sweeping tariffs.

'Timelier return' to 2% inflation needed, Warsh says, hiking benchmark for first time since 2023

By Christopher Rugaber ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Federal Reserve raised its benchmark interest rate Wednesday for the first time since 2023 in an effort to quell stubbornly high inflation, a move that spurred a sharp response from the

White House.

The quarter-point increase lifts the Fed's key rate to about 3.9% and, over time, could result in higher borrowing costs for mortgages, auto loans and credit cards. In a set of quarterly projections, the Fed also signaled that its rate-setting committee expects to hike rates a

second time later this year to 4.1%.

"Today's policy action will support a timelier return" to the central bank's 2% inflation goal, the Fed said in a statement.

The move comes as Americans are already struggling with high costs for groceries, gas and housing. Affordability has taken on a leading role in the upcoming midterm elections.

In a news conference following the Fed's announcement, Fed Chair

Kevin Warsh said that while the job market remains resilient, inflation has stubbornly remained above the Fed 2% target for years.

"The plain fact is that inflation is too high and has been for too long," Warsh said.

Since taking the lead at the Fed in May, Warsh has said the Fed is committed to taming inflation and that policymakers would take their

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At least a dozen waterfowl have died along the downtown lakefront in recent months, prompting advocates and experts to suspect botulism worsened by climate change



IN HOT WATER

By Adriana Pérez CHICAGO TRIBUNE

In the soft shimmer of the water near DuSable Harbor, several Canada geese and a double-crested cormorant foraged among aquatic plants, the former nibbling on the feather-like leaves and the latter diving time and again for fish. By the docks and boats, an American black duck preened itself. Near the geese, a dead bird floated next to trash and vegetation. It likely fell victim to a lurking danger that has killed at least a dozen waterfowl along the lakefront downtown in recent months, according to county and state officials. The Illinois Department of Natural Resources confirmed that it had received reports of dead

Ducks groom themselves at Burnham Harbor at Lake Michigan in Chicago on Wednesday. A lurking danger has killed at least a dozen waterfowl along the lakefront in recent months, with the state testing carcasses for clues. TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

mallard ducks in DuSable Harbor and picked up carcasses Aug. 21 for diagnostic testing. The University of Illinois College of Veterinary Medicine Diagnostic Laboratory tested one of the birds and shared with Cook County and the state agency on Sept. 11 that the cause of death was not apparent, and that the test results were inconclusive. Tissues have been frozen for additional testing. According to an IDNR spokesperson on Monday, the results of histopathology — the study of diseased cells and tissues with a microscope — is pending. Advocates and other experts, however, suspect that the birds succumbed to avian botulism. It is not an uncommon disease among waterfowl, especially

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'BROADVIEW SIX'

Defense demands Boutros, DC files

Attorneys plead for answers about DOJ involvement in case

By Jason Meisner CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Lawyers for the "Broadview Six" are urging a federal judge to order the Chicago U.S. attorney's office to divulge any communications with officials in Washington about the controversial case, saying in a filing late Tuesday that the government's "hair-splitting" response so far was just one indication of an ongoing cover-up. In the 61-page filing, the attorneys pointed to allegedly evasive answers from U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros' office about any involvement of Department of Justice officials when it came to bringing or prosecuting the charges, which collapsed in spectacular fashion in May amid allegations of prosecutorial misconduct. The filing highlighted a recent email exchange with the "well-respected" prosecutor Boutros appointed to help stave off the controversy, in which she repeatedly deferred to the "front office" in saying they were not aware of any communications "in which it took direction" from anyone higher up the food chain. "The insertion of the word 'direction' seems intended to provide a clever, subjective escape hatch from the candor and transparency promised by the U.S. attorney and desperately needed to identify and

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INSIDE 'A rapist in a police uniform'?

A jury is deliberating after hearing a series of women testify over the past week that they thought U.S. Customs and Border Protection agent Luis Uribe was "the fake police," a man posing as law enforcement who was robbing and sexually assaulting Chinese sex workers in Chicago-area hotel rooms. Chicagoland

■ O'Hare, Midway again ranked below average in customer satisfaction survey. Business

Board rejects Hawthorne's request to run in '27

By Robert McCoppin CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Illinois Racing Board rejected Hawthorne Race Course's request for racing dates for 2027, deeming its application "deficient." Despite going bankrupt, closing and selling their property this year, track officials filed a request to conduct racing next year, without publicly specifying where or how they could do so. At the board's meeting Wednesday, a racing board official said Hawthorne was given a chance to correct its application, but "remained deficient and did not comply with the (state law) act or the rules." In bankruptcy court, Hawthorne

previously agreed to sell the track for \$90 million to a buyer that The Real Deal identified as Digital Realty, with plans to build a data center on the property. However, the Stickney Village Board put a six-month moratorium on data centers, and officials in neighboring Cicero also expressed opposition, leaving the property's future uncertain. As a result of the closure and sale, about 500 residents and an almost equal number of horses were required to move out of the track's backstretch by the end of August. Most residents found apartments in the area, while some traveled with many of the horses to

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Patrons leave after the last race of the day at Hawthorne Race Course in Stickney on July 19. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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